

★ Sleeping Beauty ★

an old fairy tale, told again



Sleeping Beauty

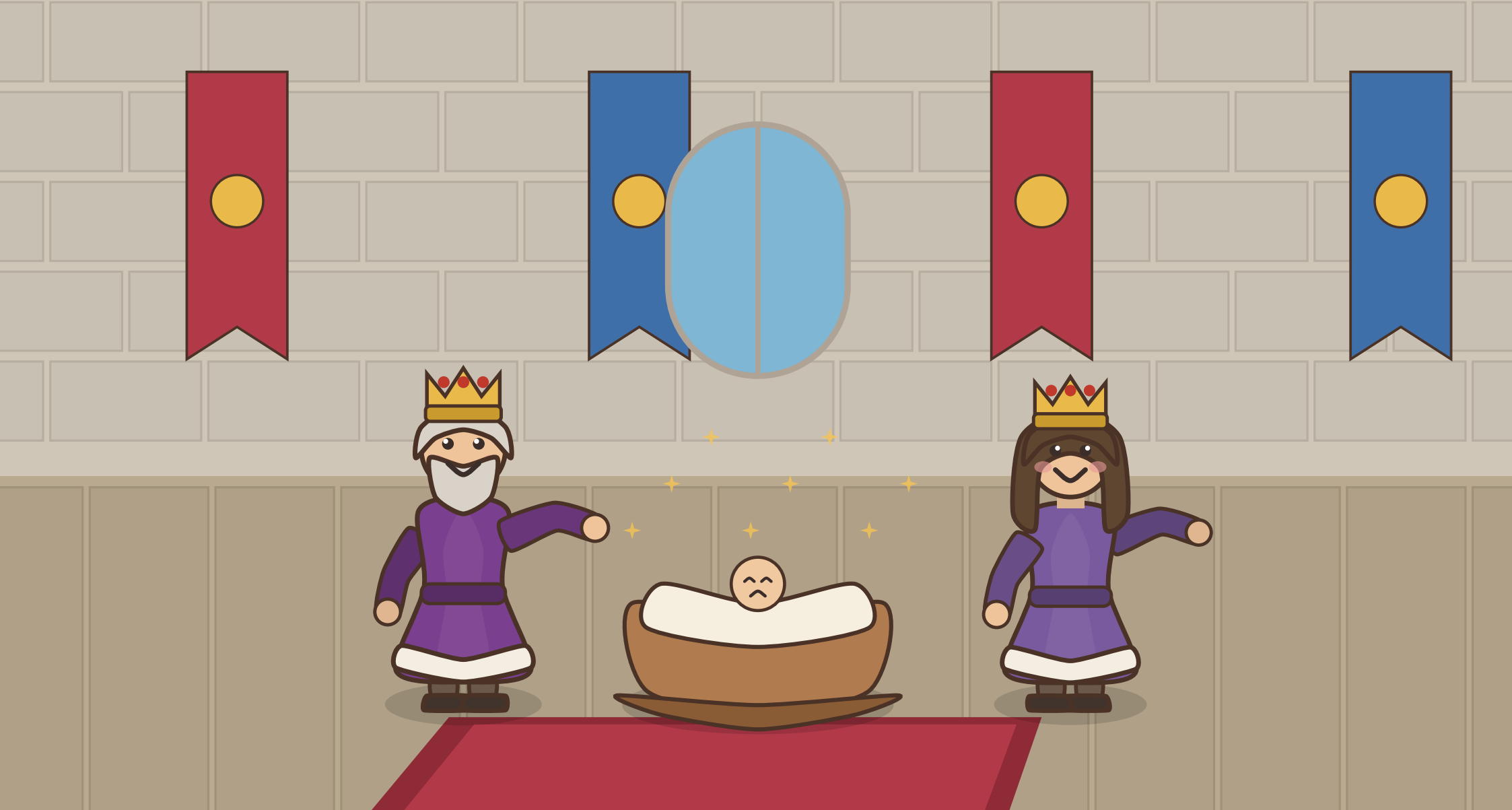
after the story by Charles Perrault



This book belongs to

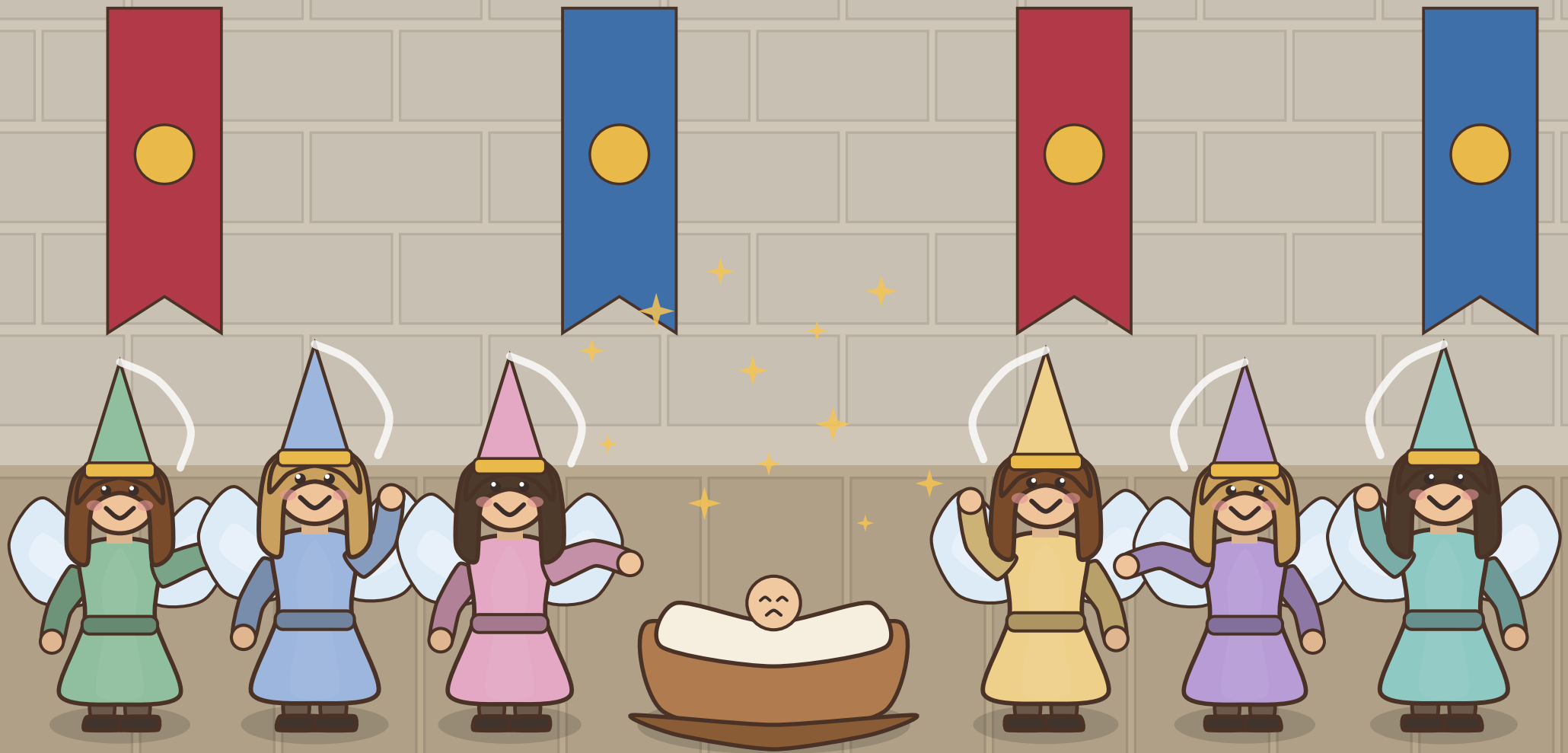
A retelling of “La Belle au bois dormant”, printed by Charles Perrault in 1697.

Illustrations drawn as vector art. Made to be read aloud.

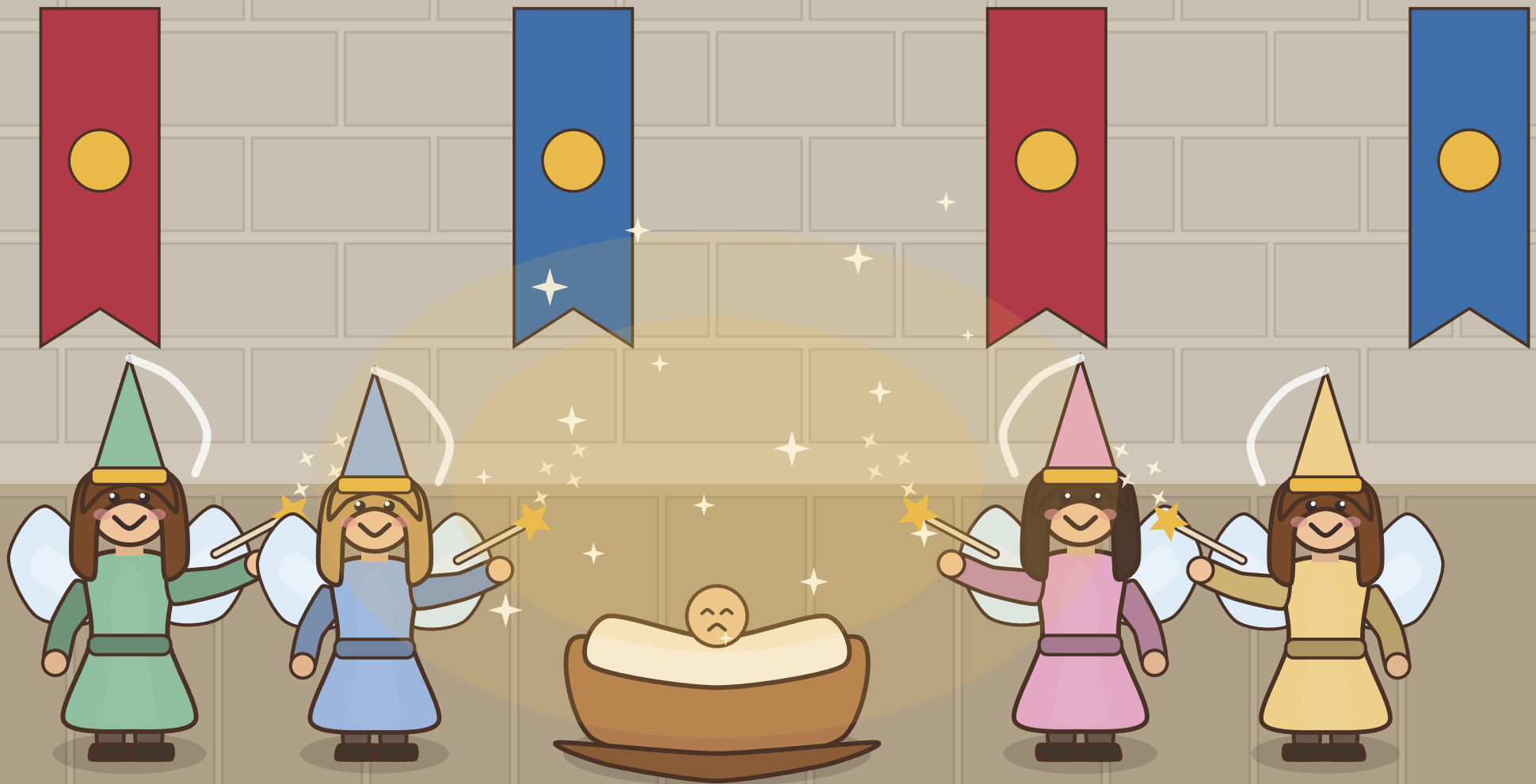


A King and a Queen had wished for a child for a very long time, and at last one came.

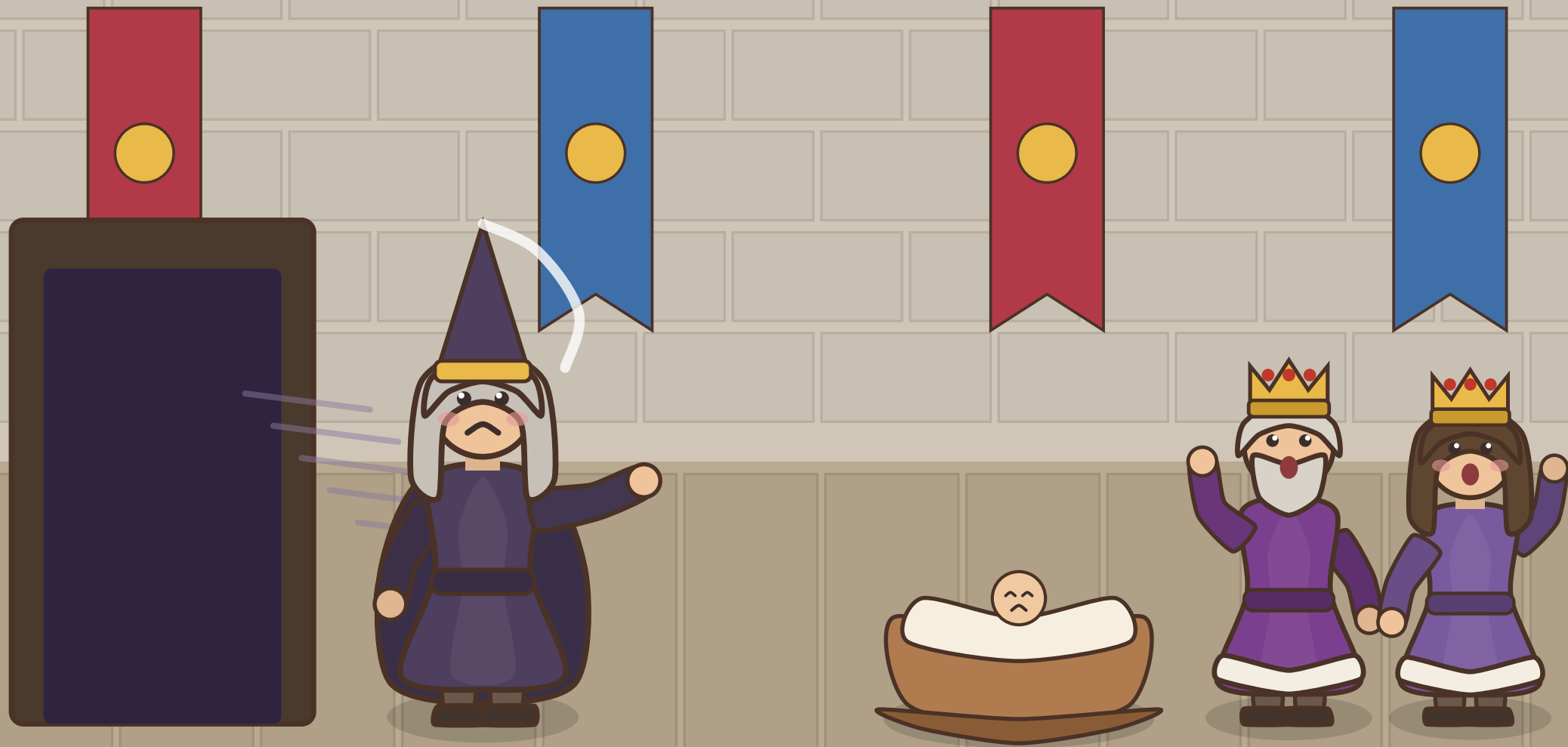
They were so pleased that they invited the whole kingdom to the christening.



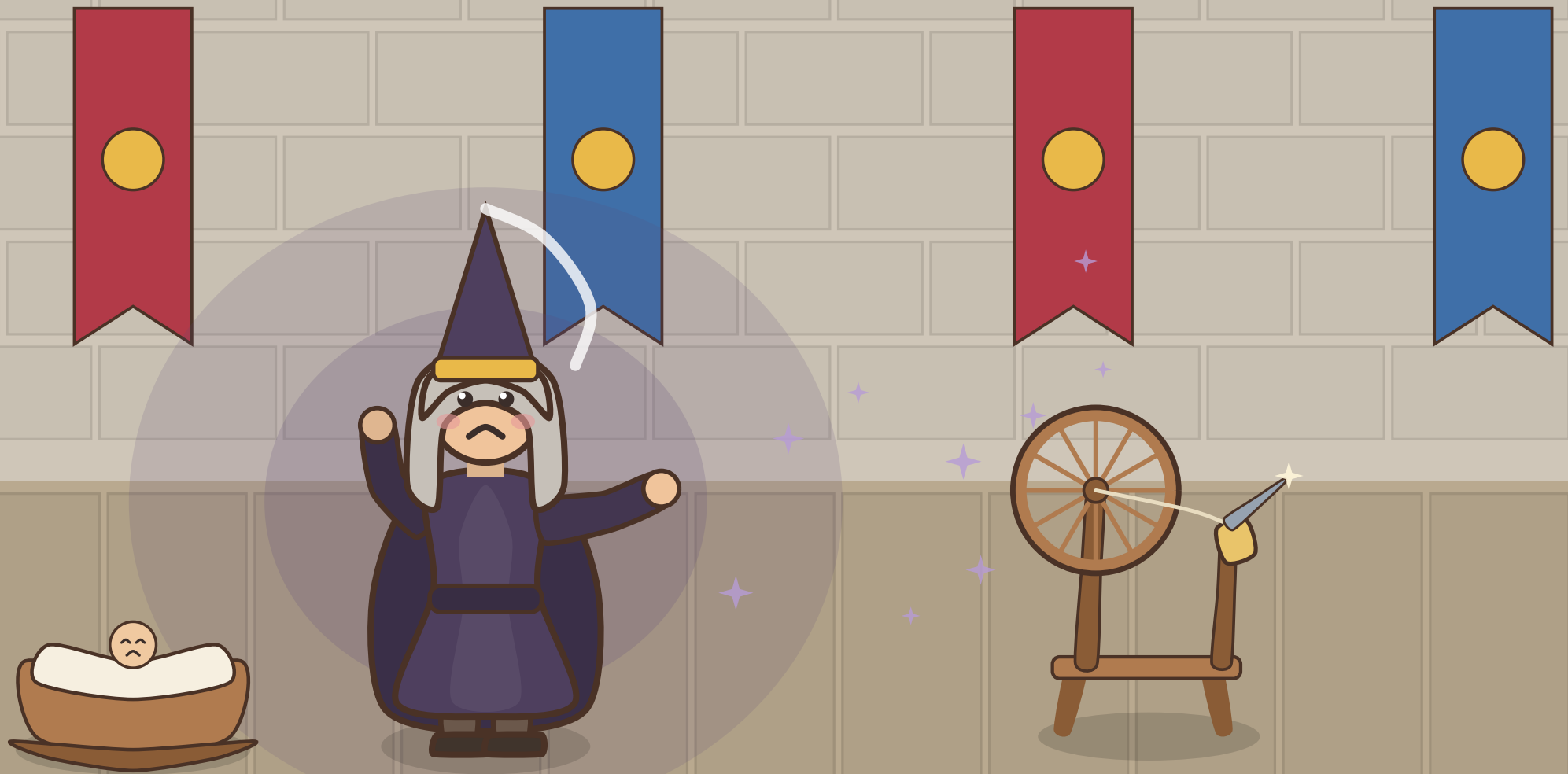
Seven fairies were asked to be godmothers, and each was given a gold plate and a gold spoon, and each one leaned over the cradle to give a gift.



“She shall be kind,” said the first. “She shall be clever,” said the second. Dancing, said the third. Singing, said the fourth. Music, said the fifth. And laughing, said the sixth — “which is worth more than all of it.”



Then the door banged.
In came a very old fairy that nobody had invited, because everybody had
thought she was dead, or abroad, or both.



“Here is my gift,” she said. “One day the Princess will prick her finger on a spindle. And that will be that.”

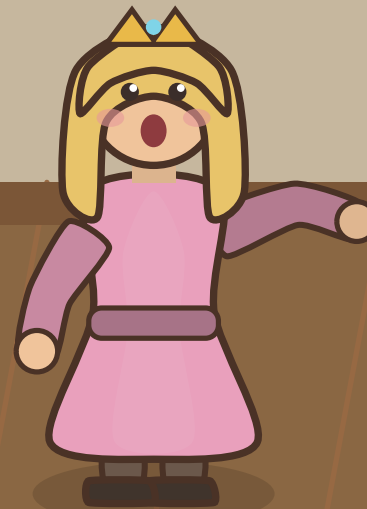
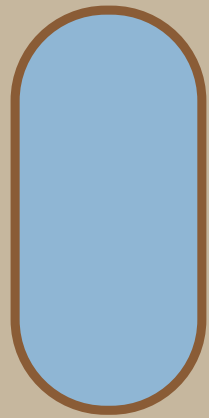
Then she went out, and the door banged again.



But the seventh fairy had not given her gift yet.
“I cannot undo it,” she said. “But I can soften it. She will not die. She will sleep
a hundred years — and then somebody will come.”



The King had every spindle in the kingdom collected and burnt, and made a law about it, and felt a good deal better.



Sixteen years went by.

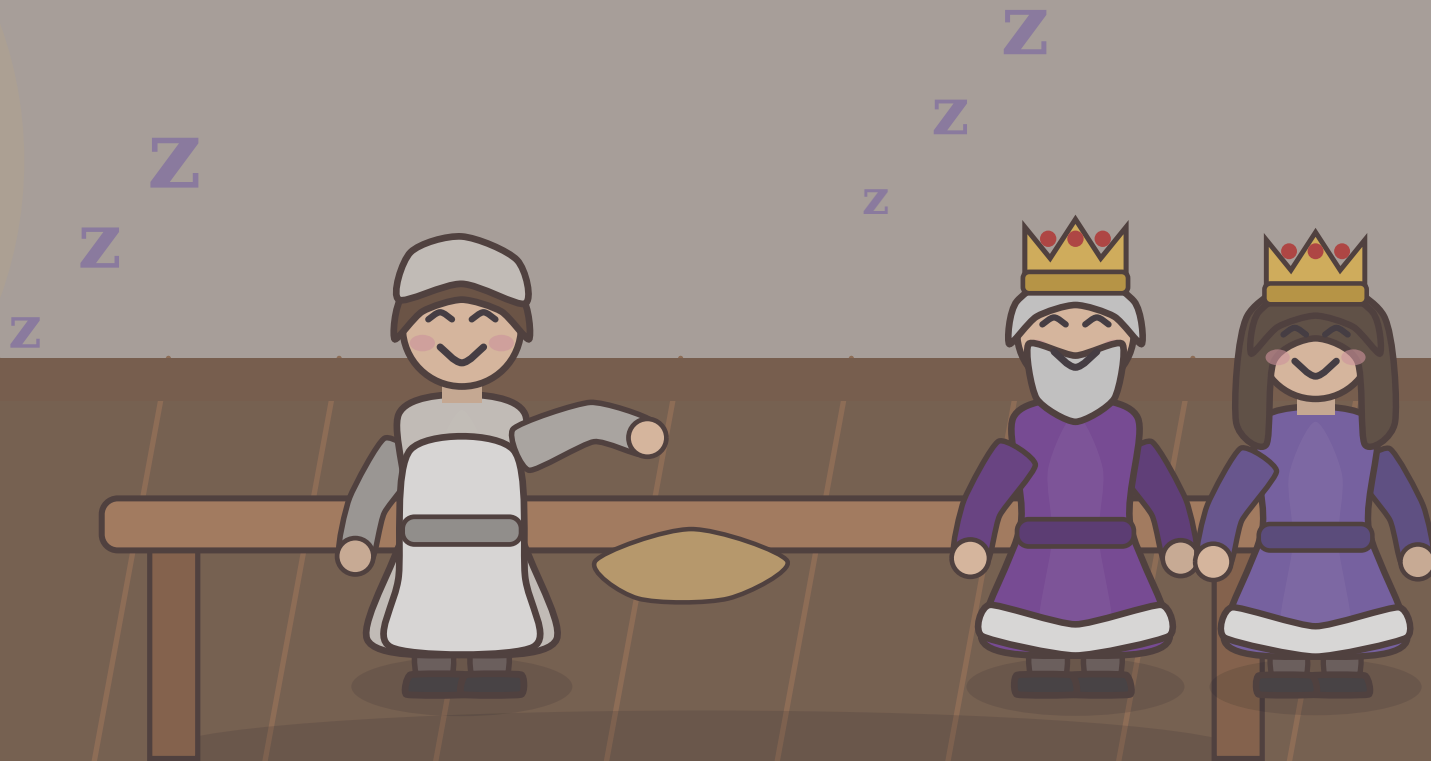
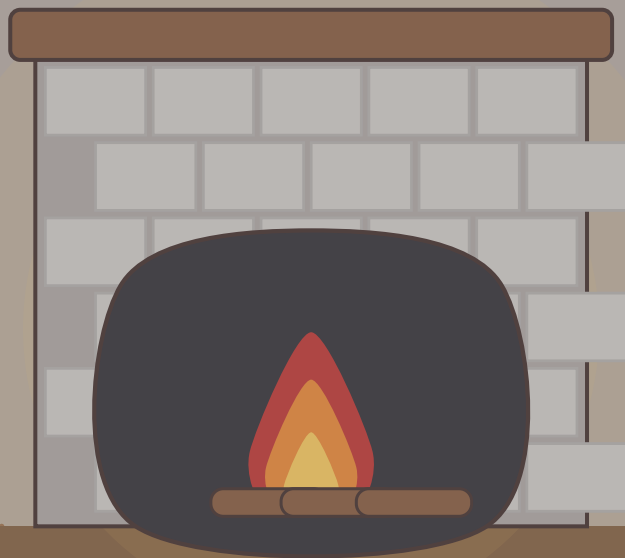
One afternoon the Princess was running up a staircase she had never been up before, and at the top she found a little room, and in it an old woman, spinning.



“What is that?” said the Princess, who had never seen a spindle in her life.

“Try it,” said the old woman.

She touched it — and fell asleep before she reached the floor.



The seventh fairy came at once. “She will be lonely,” she said, “waking up on her own.”

So she put the whole castle to sleep: the King, the Queen, the cook, the dogs, the fire in the grate and the birds on the roof.



And a wood grew up around it. Not a nice wood. Thorns as thick as your arm, and brambles over the top, until the highest tower looked like the last mast of a sinking ship.

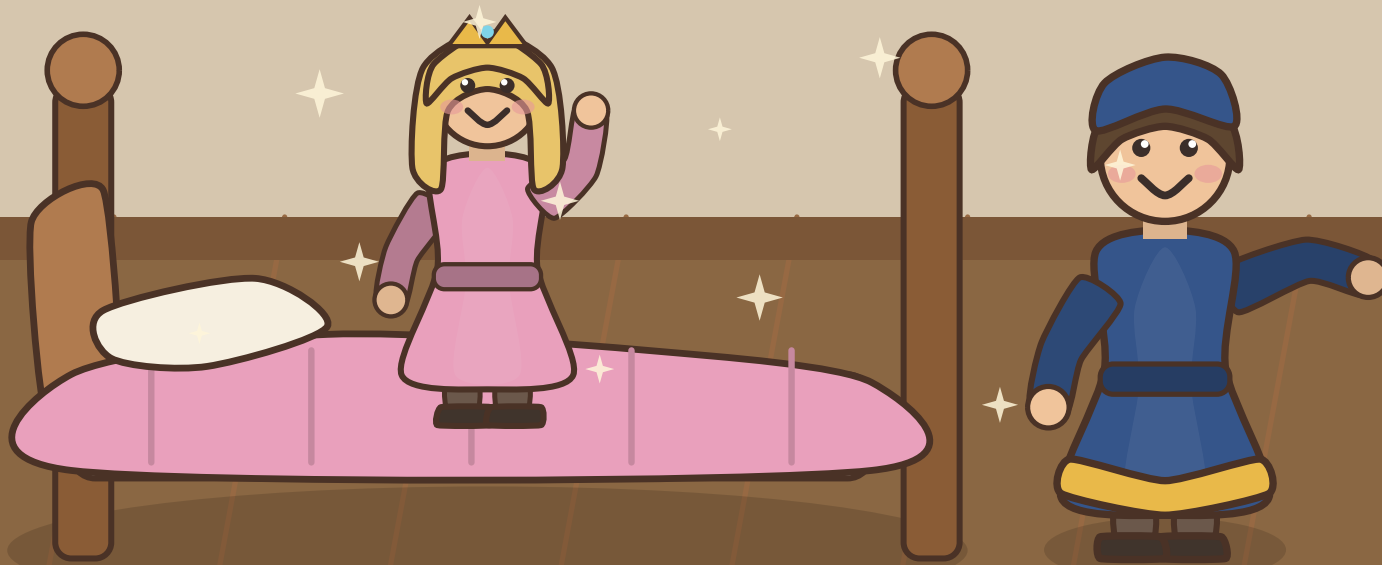
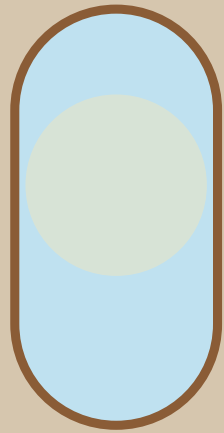


A hundred years later a prince came riding by and asked what was behind the thorns.

An old man told him what his grandfather had told him. So the prince got down off his horse and walked up to the hedge.

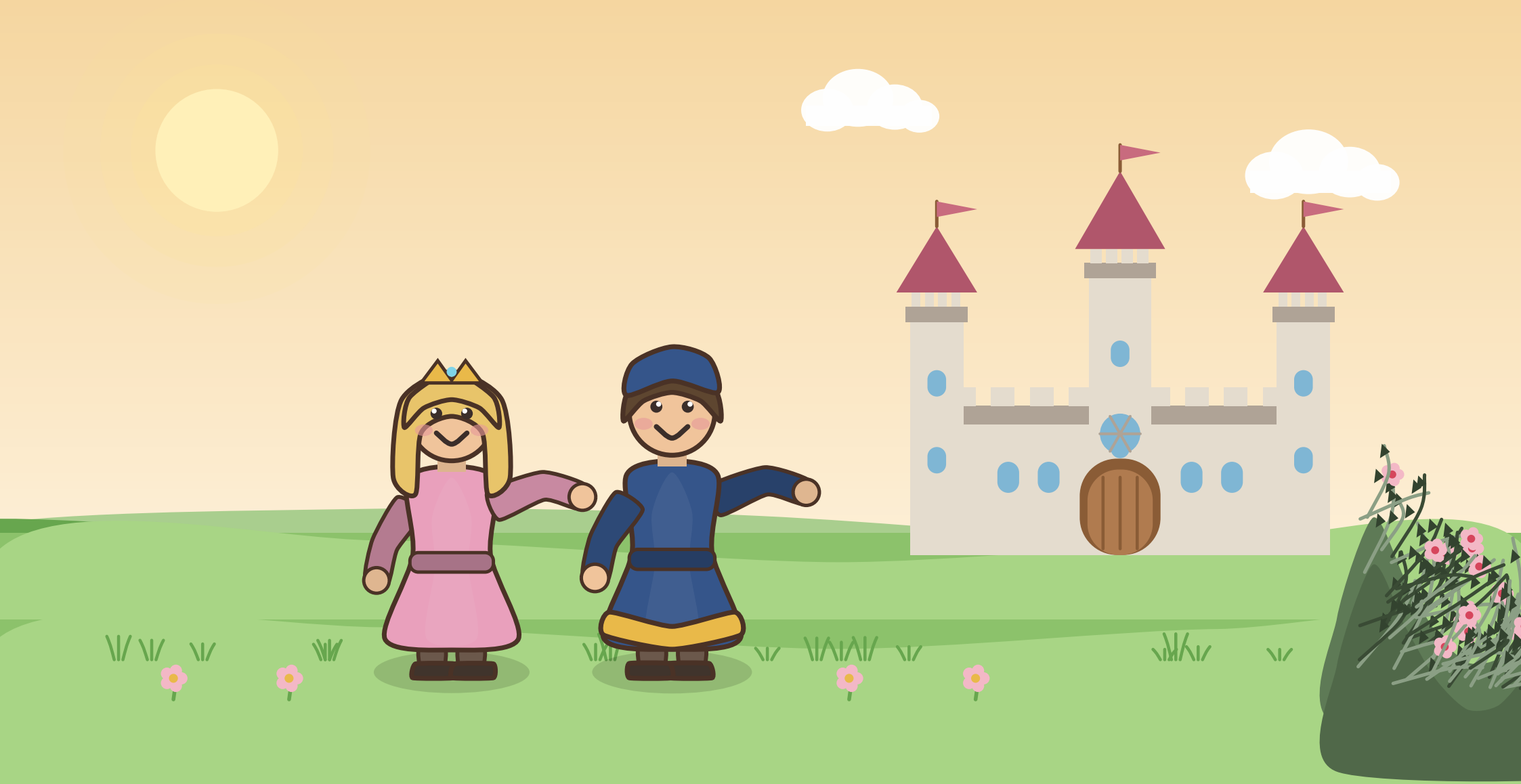


And the thorns opened, all by themselves, and closed again behind him.
He went through the sleeping castle, past the sleeping cook and the sleeping
dogs, and up the little staircase.



She opened her eyes. “Oh,” she said. “Is it you? You have been a very long time.”

And all over the castle the fire crackled, and the dogs barked, and the cook went on basting the chicken exactly where he had left off.



The End

“She will sleep a hundred years,
and then somebody will come.”

